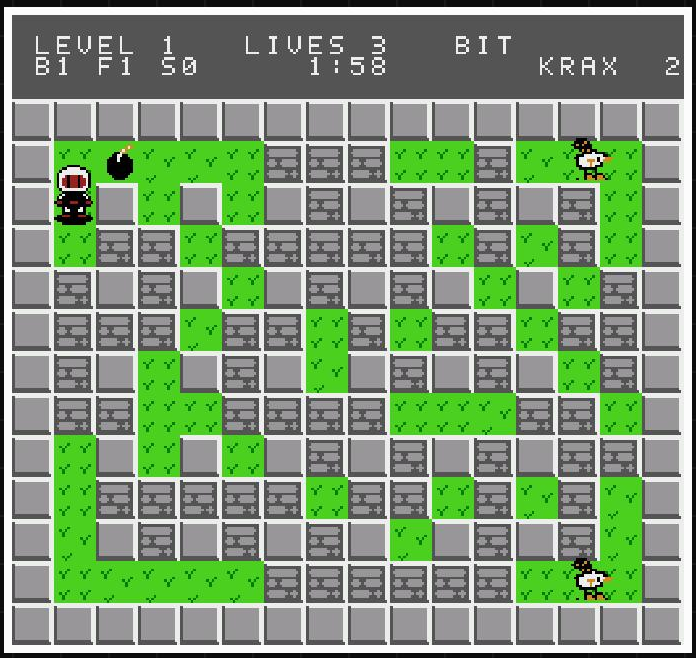
1-2 PLAYERS

BOMB YARD



INSTRUCTION BOOKLET



THE STORY

Nobody has worked the old quarry for a hundred years. All that is left are concrete pillars, piles of stone, and a crate of bombs the stonecutters forgot.

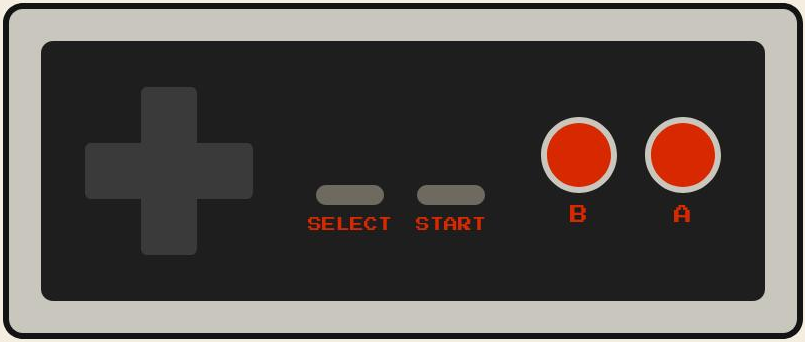
But the stone piles hid eggs. One night they hatched, and out came the **Krax**: small, angry birds with orange beaks that waddle about knocking over everything they meet. Now they rule the whole quarry.



BIT
has lived at the edge of the quarry all his life. He finds the bomb crate and sets out to clear the Krax, one part of the quarry at a time.

There is a catch. The quarry is built on old blasting rock that starts to rumble the moment a bomb goes off. In each part of the quarry Bit has exactly **two minutes** before the roof caves in.

Help Bit blast every creature out of The Yard, the Sand Pit, the Frost Cave, Lava Peak, Cloud Nine and the Deep Sea!



CONTROL PAD	Walk. A quick tap moves exactly one square. On the title screen, pick 1 player, 2 players or boss rush.
A OR B	Drop a bomb where you stand. It goes off after 3 seconds. With the remote, B sets your bombs off instead.
START	Start the game. During play, either player can pause and resume. The clock stops while paused.
SELECT	On the title screen, switch Debug Mode on or off (1 player only). See page 7.
CONTROLLER 2	Player 2 plays Red, the red bomber, with the same buttons. See page 6.

HOW TO PLAY

Blast both monsters to clear the level. Bombs send fire straight out in four directions. Fire burns for one second and stops at the first block it hits. Careful: your own fire hurts you too!



LEVEL
Which part of the quarry you are in.

B F S R
Your bombs, fire range and skates, and R while you hold the remote.

TIME
Two minutes per level. At 0:00 the roof caves in.

MONSTERS
The level's monster and how many are still loose.



Concrete. Can't be blasted.



Stone. Cracks open and drops a power-up.



Bomb. Nobody can walk through it.



Fire. Sets off other bombs it touches.

0:20 When 20 seconds are left the music speeds up. In the last 10 seconds the clock blinks. Hurry!

POWER-UPS

Bit starts with **1 bomb** and a blast of **1 square**. Every level hides **bomb-ups, fire-ups and skates**, 1 to 7 of each (5 unless you change ITEMS on the options screen), and, with 1 player, **1 heart** under its stones. Bombs and fire have no limit, and you keep your power-ups from level to level.



BOMB-UP
One more bomb on the field at a time.



FIRE-UP
Your blast reaches one square further.



SKATE
Walk 25% faster. Up to 4 skates, for double speed.



PENETRATOR
Blasts go through stone and break every block in reach. 2 per level; lost if you die.



REMOTE
Bombs wait until you press B, then all go off. 2 per level; lost if you die.

WHO'S WHO



BIT. Our hero, the white bomber. That's you!



KRAX. Wanders the Yard. Each level has its own creatures (page 5). One touch and you're out.

THE LEVELS



Every level is a brand-new random quarry with its own creatures, quicker the deeper Bit goes. After every level waits a boss from that level.



LEVEL 1

THE YARD

Green grass at the top of the quarry, home of the Krax. Their crowned king is the boss.





LEVEL 2

SAND PIT

A hot, dry pit. Asps rear up out of the sand, and a giant scorpion waits.





LEVEL 3

FROST CAVE

An icy cave full of little yetis, guarded by a woolly mammoth.



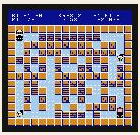


LEVEL 4

LAVA PEAK

Smoking rock and glowing cracks. Fire imps fly about, and a dragon rules.





LEVEL 5

CLOUD NINE

Golden gates above the clouds. Angels, and a storm cloud full of lightning.





LEVEL 6

DEEP SEA

Coral on the sea floor. Clownfish, and a shark for a boss.





AFTER THE SHARK

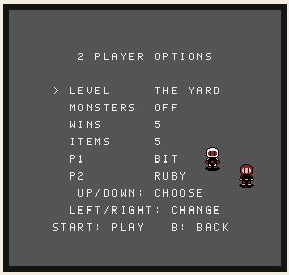
THE FINAL BOSS

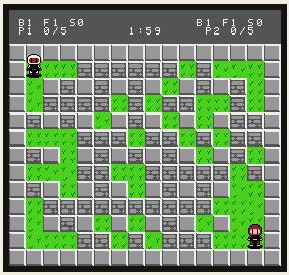
The green bomber, back in the Yard. Each boss is tougher: 3 to 8 hits, more bombs, longer blasts. Halfway it turns angry.



TWO PLAYERS

While the Krax sleep, Bit's cousin **Red** challenges him to a bomb duel. Plug in controller 2, choose **2 PLAYERS** on the title screen and press START.





LEVEL	Six arenas, from The Yard to the Deep Sea.
MONSTERS	On: two of the level's monsters roam the arena, and whoever touches one is out.
WINS	Rounds needed to win the match: 3, 5 or 10.
ITEMS	Bomb-ups, fire-ups and skates per arena: 1 to 7 of each.
P1 / P2	Your bomber: Bit, Ruby, Sky or Nova. You can't both pick the same one.

Up/down picks a line, left/right changes it. START plays, B goes back.

- Catch the other bomber in your blast to win the round.
- Both out at once, or time runs out? It's a draw and nobody scores.
- Every round is a new arena, and power-ups start over.
- The top of the screen shows wins, like **P1 2/5**.

WINNING





Clear all six levels and beat all seven bosses to see the **CONGRATULATIONS!** screen. Press START to play again.

Caught by a monster, burned in a blast, or out of time? You try the same level again on a new quarry.

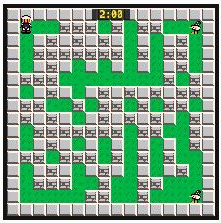
DEBUG MODE

In 1 player mode, press SELECT on the title screen until DEBUG ON shows. Bit can then walk straight through every wall and can't be hurt by fire, monsters or the clock.

BIT'S TIPS

1. **Plan your escape** before you drop a bomb. Fire only goes in straight lines, so duck around a corner.
2. **Blast stone early.** Extra bombs and fire make the monsters much easier.
3. **Let the monsters come to you.** Drop a bomb in the hallway they are heading into, then step away.
4. **Watch out for chain reactions.** One bomb can set off the next sooner than you think.

Bomb Yard also runs in any web browser, on a computer or a phone. Before you start, pick a look in the menu. Your choice is remembered for next time. The rules are the same in both.



CLASSIC MODE

The original pixel art and the same chiptune songs as the NES cart. Bit faces two monsters in each level, the same as on the NES.



NEW ENHANCED MODE

3D blocks seen at a tilt, glowing fire, shadows and screen shake. New monsters and modern music.

Enhanced music, level by level: tropical house, desert deep house, ambient synthwave, a dark dirge with a tolling bell, then organ and choir.

ENHANCED MONSTERS



WANDERERS

Krax, yetis, slimes and fish roam about.



CHARGERS

Asps and beetles charge down corridors at you.



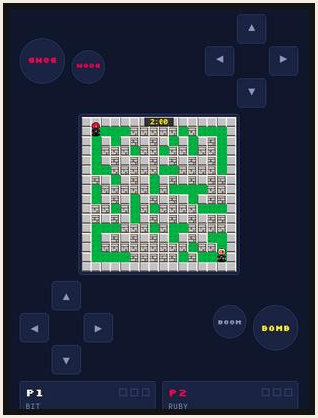
HUNTERS

Imps, angels and wisps fly after you.

Every level has its own creatures, and every boss is new.

In the menu, choose **1P VS MONSTERS**, **2 PLAYERS**, **BOSS RUSH** (only the seven bosses) or **DEBUG** (walk through walls, can't die). The yard is bigger on the web: 16 by 16 squares.

1 PLAYER	Arrow keys or W A S D to walk. Space or X drops a bomb, Z or C sets off remote bombs.
PLAYER 1	In 2 players: W A S D, Space, and E for the remote.
PLAYER 2	In 2 players: arrow keys, Enter, and right Shift for the remote.
P / ESC, M	Pause and resume. M turns the sound on or off.
DRAG	New enhanced mode: drag the arena with a finger or the mouse to tilt it. Double-tap or double-click resets.



ON A PHONE

Use the arrows and the BOMB button on the screen. BOOM, beside it, lights up green with the remote and sets your bombs off. With 2 players, lay the phone flat between you: player 2's buttons sit at the top, turned to face across the table.

2 PLAYER MATCH

First to **3 rounds** wins. Each round moves to the next level, from The Yard all the way to the Deep Sea. No monsters.

Bomb Yard is on the Sega Mega Drive too, with the same rules as on the NES. Everything you see and hear is new.



GRAPHICS

Shaded pixel art. Blocks cast shadows, fire flickers and bombs flash red before they blow. Each level has its own colours.

MUSIC

The NES tunes rearranged for the FM synth, plus new title and boss songs.

SOUND

Sampled effects: deep explosions, a sparkle for the heart, a clang for the boss.

The ROM is md/bomb-yard.bin and runs in any Mega Drive emulator. Player 2 uses controller 2.

D-PAD	Walk. Title: 1 player, 2 players or boss rush
A B C	Drop a bomb (any of the three). With the remote, B sets your bombs off
START	Start, pause and play on
B	Options screen: go back
C	Title screen: debug mode, walk through walls, can't die

On the options screen, pick your bomber: Bit, Ruby, Sky or Nova, each in their own colours. With 1 player or boss rush there is also DEBUG: walk through walls and never die.

THE SCREEN

Left panel: your bombs (an arrowed bomb once you hold the penetrator), blast range, skates, lives and, at the bottom, the remote while you hold it. Right panel: monsters left (FOES), the boss's hits to go, or player 2. Top: the level and the clock, which turns yellow in the last 20 seconds while the music speeds up.

THE BOSSES



A creature from each level: the Krax King, a scorpion, a mammoth, a dragon, a storm cloud, the shark, and last the green bomber, back in the Yard. Each is tougher: 3 to 8 hits, more bombs, a longer blast and more speed. Halfway it turns angry. Only your bombs hurt it.

BOMB YARD



HOW TO PLAY THIS CART

Open bomb-yard.nes in an NES emulator such as Mesen or FCEUX. On a real console, use a flash cart that supports mapper 0 (NROM).

No emulator? Open web/bomb-yard.html in a browser for Classic or New enhanced mode (page 8).

The source code is at github.com/martin79grahn/bomb-yard-nes.

A HOMEBREW GAME
BY MARTIN GRAHN

© 2026